

KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES TO ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569–88

Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558–88

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home			
L2: KT2.2: Relations with Spain			
L3: KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88			
L4: KT2.4: The Armada			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the reasons for, and the significance of, the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569–70).
- ☐ Analyse the key features and significance of the Ridolfi, Throckmorton, and Babington plots.
- ☐ Evaluate the methods used by Sir Francis Walsingham and his use of spies to uncover treason.
- ☐ Explain the reasons for, and the immense geopolitical significance of, Mary, Queen of Scots' execution in 1587.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Why did Mary, Queen of Scots flee to England in 1568?

What was Elizabeth's immediate reaction to Mary's arrival?

Why was Mary, Queen of Scots a massive threat to Elizabeth?

What was the Casket Letters affair?

What was the Papal Bull of 1570?

What was the 'Crucifix Controversy'?

What were the Royal Injunctions?

How much debt did Elizabeth inherit?

What was the 'Auld Alliance'?

What did William Harvey discover?

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least TWO of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Treason Excommunication

General Notes

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Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Which plot posed the greatest danger to Elizabeth's life?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q1. Describe one feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70.

Exam Q2. Describe one feature of the Ridolfi plot.

Exam Q3. Describe one feature of the Throckmorton plot.

Exam Q4. Describe one feature of the Babington plot.

Exam Q5. Describe one feature of Sir Francis Walsingham's use of spies.

Exam Q6. Explain why the Revolt of the Northern Earls took place in 1569. Stimulus: Loss of political power / Religion

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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Exam Q7. Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots, was executed in 1587. [Aligned to Spec Topic]
Stimulus: The Babington Plot / Sir Francis Walsingham

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Exam Q8. 'The main reason for the failure of Catholic plots against Elizabeth was the work of Sir Francis Walsingham.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Spies / Lack of foreign support

Exam Q9. 'The Revolt of the Northern Earls was the most significant challenge to Elizabeth's rule in the years 1569–86.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Earl of Northumberland / Babington's execution (1586)

L2: KT2.2: Relations with Spain

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the complex roots of the Anglo-Spanish conflict, focusing on religious, political, and commercial rivalry.
- ☐ Explain the significance of English involvement in the Netherlands, specifically the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch.
- ☐ Analyse the causes and Philip II's strategic plan for the Spanish Armada.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for the Armada's catastrophic failure, weighing English tactics against Spanish mistakes and the weather.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569)?

What was the Ridolfi Plot (1571)?

What was the Throckmorton Plot (1583)?

What was the Babington Plot (1586)?

Who was Francis Walsingham?

Why did Mary, Queen of Scots flee to England in 1568?

What was the Casket Letters affair?

Who was the Pope that excommunicated Elizabeth in 1570?

What was the Act of Uniformity?

Who published the Germ Theory?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Privateer Treaty of Nonsuch (1585) Galleon Fireships

Your Sentence:

General Notes

[illegible]

Pair & Share Activity

Q2. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why did relations with Spain deteriorate so badly by the 1580s?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q1. Describe one feature of English privateering in the New World.

Exam Q2. Describe one feature of the religious rivalry between England and Spain.

Exam Q3. Describe one feature of Sir Francis Drake's activities in the Americas.

Exam Q4. Explain why relations between England and Spain became worse in the years 1569–88. Stimulus: Catholic rebels in England / English trade in the Netherlands

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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Exam Q5. 'Commercial rivalry was the main cause of the growing tension between England and Spain in the years 1570–88.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Privateering / Religious differences

L3: KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the reasons for deteriorating relations with Spain, focusing on religious shifts, the Genoese Loan, the assassination of William of Orange, and the Treaty of Joinville.
- ☐ Analyse the significance of English direct involvement in the Netherlands through the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch and the actions of Robert Dudley.
- ☐ Evaluate the strategic impact of Francis Drake's preemptive raid on Cadiz in 1587 ('Singeing the King of Spain's beard').

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Why was Philip II of Spain angry with Elizabeth?

What was a 'privateer'?

Which famous English privateer constantly raided Spanish treasure ships?

What was the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585)?

How much gold did Drake capture from the Spanish ship Cacafuego?

Who was Francis Walsingham?

What was the Babington Plot (1586)?

What was the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569)?

Why was Mary, Queen of Scots a threat?

What was the 'Vestment Controversy'?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Privateer**

General Notes

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Pair & Share Activity

Q3. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Was the outbreak of war with Spain in 1585 inevitable?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q1. Describe one feature of English involvement in the Netherlands, 1585–88.

Exam Q2. Describe one feature of Drake’s raid on Cadiz in 1587.

Exam Q3. Describe one feature of Robert Dudley's actions in the Netherlands.

Exam Q4. Explain why Elizabeth signed the Treaty of Nonsuch in 1585. Stimulus: The Netherlands / Dutch Protestant rebels

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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Exam Q5. 'Drake's raid on Cadiz was the most important reason for the delay of the Spanish Armada.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Wooden barrel staves / Financial impact on Spain

L4: KT2.4: The Armada

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the complex, overlapping reasons why Philip II finally decided to launch the Spanish Armada in 1588.
- ☐ Analyse the Spanish invasion plans, highlighting the critical logistical flaws from the very beginning.
- ☐ Evaluate the intersecting reasons for the English victory, weighing English tactics against Spanish mistakes and the weather.
- ☐ Explain the immense domestic and international consequences of the Armada's defeat.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What did Drake do in Cadiz in 1587?

What phrase did Drake use to describe his attack on Cadiz?

When was Mary, Queen of Scots executed?

How did Mary's execution affect relations with Spain?

What was the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585)?

Which English privateer constantly raided Spanish ships?

What was the Throckmorton Plot (1583)?

Why did Mary, Queen of Scots flee to England?

What title did Elizabeth take in the Act of Supremacy?

How much debt did Elizabeth inherit in 1558?

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least TWO of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Armada Fireships

General Notes

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Pair & Share Activity

Q4. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why did the Spanish Armada fail?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Exam Q1. Describe one feature of the Spanish invasion plans for the Armada.

Exam Q2. Describe one feature of English tactics used to defeat the Spanish Armada.

Exam Q3. Describe one feature of the Battle of Gravelines.

Exam Q4. Explain why the Spanish Armada was defeated in 1588. Stimulus: Fireships / English ship design

[12 marks • 15 mins]

[illegible]

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Exam Q5. 'The English defeated the Spanish Armada because of superior ship design and naval tactics.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Long-range culverins / The 'Protestant Wind'
